HTTP ARCHIVE • DATA SOURCE

State of the Web 2020–2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

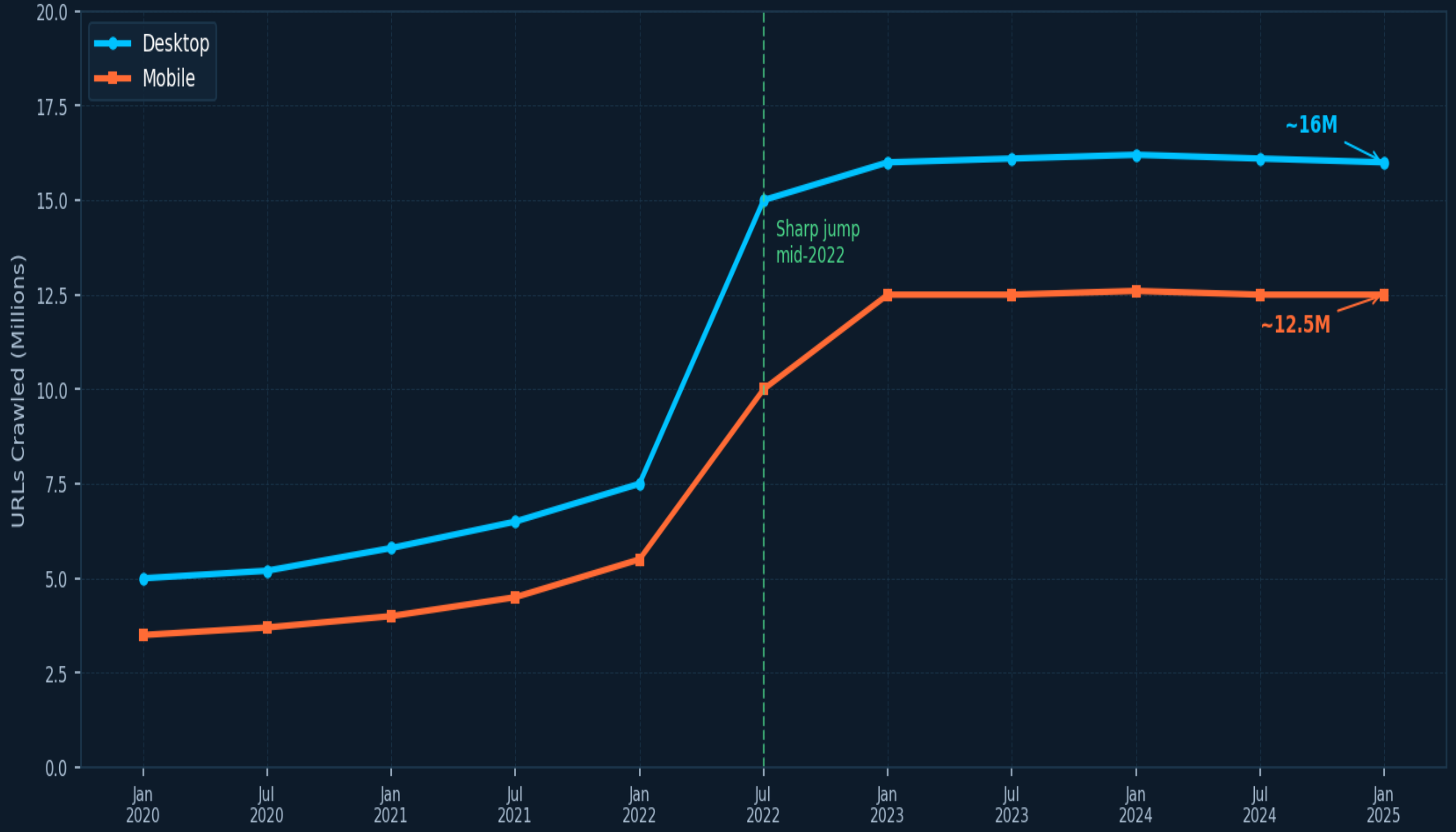
A data-driven overview of how the web has evolved in size, request patterns, protocol adoption, and security practices · HTTP Archive crawl data · Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For: Web Performance Engineers · Front-End Architects

8M → 16M	99.2%	40%	2,000 KB
Desktop URLs	HTTPS Requests	HTTP/3 Support	Median Page Weight

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

HTTP Archive measures an ever-larger slice of the web — larger samples mean more representative benchmarks



~5M
Desktop URLs
Jan 2020

~3.5M
Mobile URLs
Jan 2020

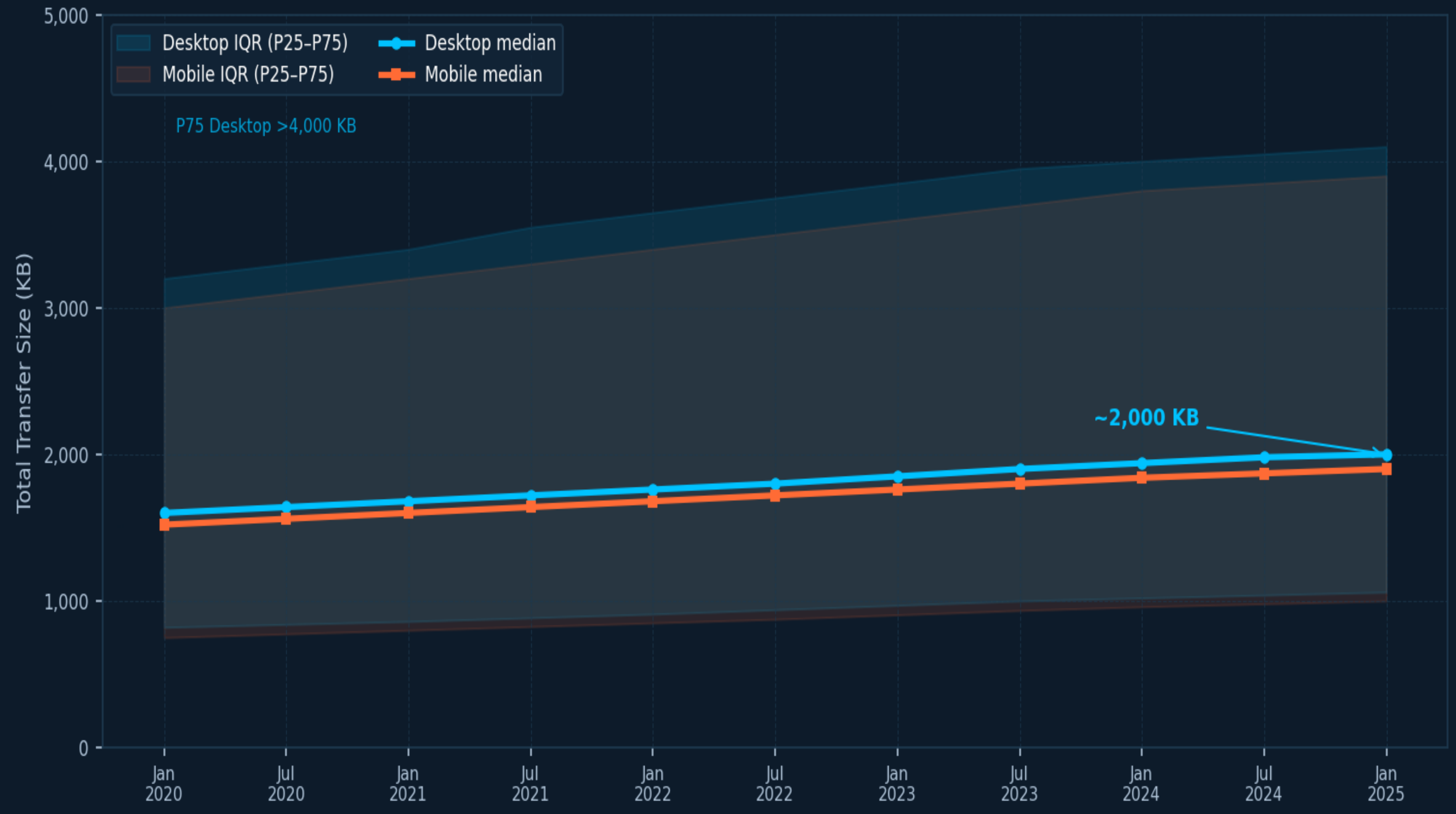
16M
Desktop URLs
Now

12.5M
Mobile URLs
Now

Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop

Total transfer size rising across all percentiles — the long tail of heavy pages is widening



Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

Request counts nudge up ~3%; multiplexing (HTTP/2 & HTTP/3) drives TCP connections down 14–27%

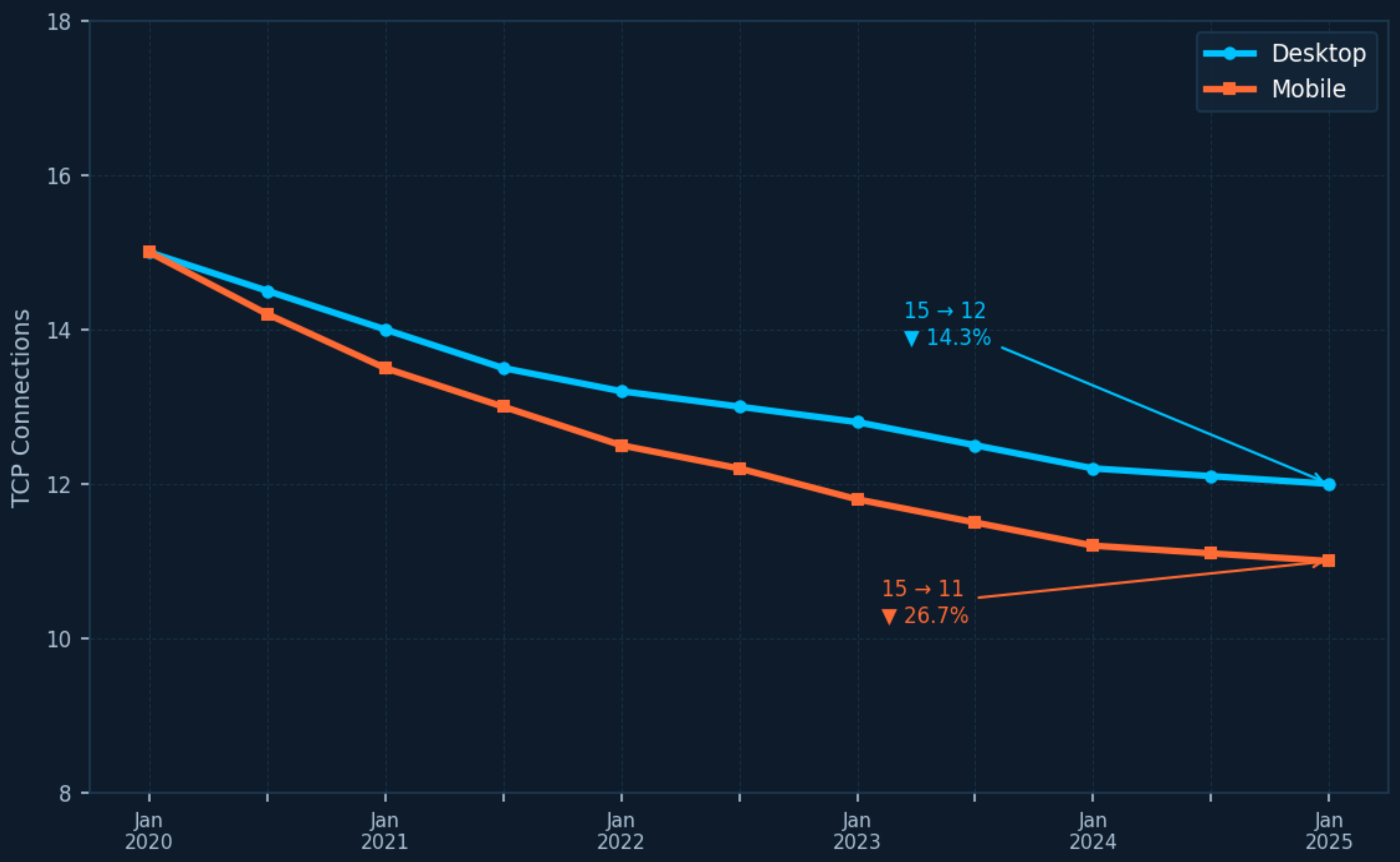
REQUESTS PER PAGE

76
Desktop (median)
▲ 2.7% since 2020

71
Mobile (median)
▲ 2.9% since 2020

Both desktop and mobile requests up ~3% over the observation period.
Requests still growing — but slowly.

TCP CONNECTIONS PER PAGE (MEDIAN)



Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

From ~80% in 2020 to 99%+ today — plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web

99%+

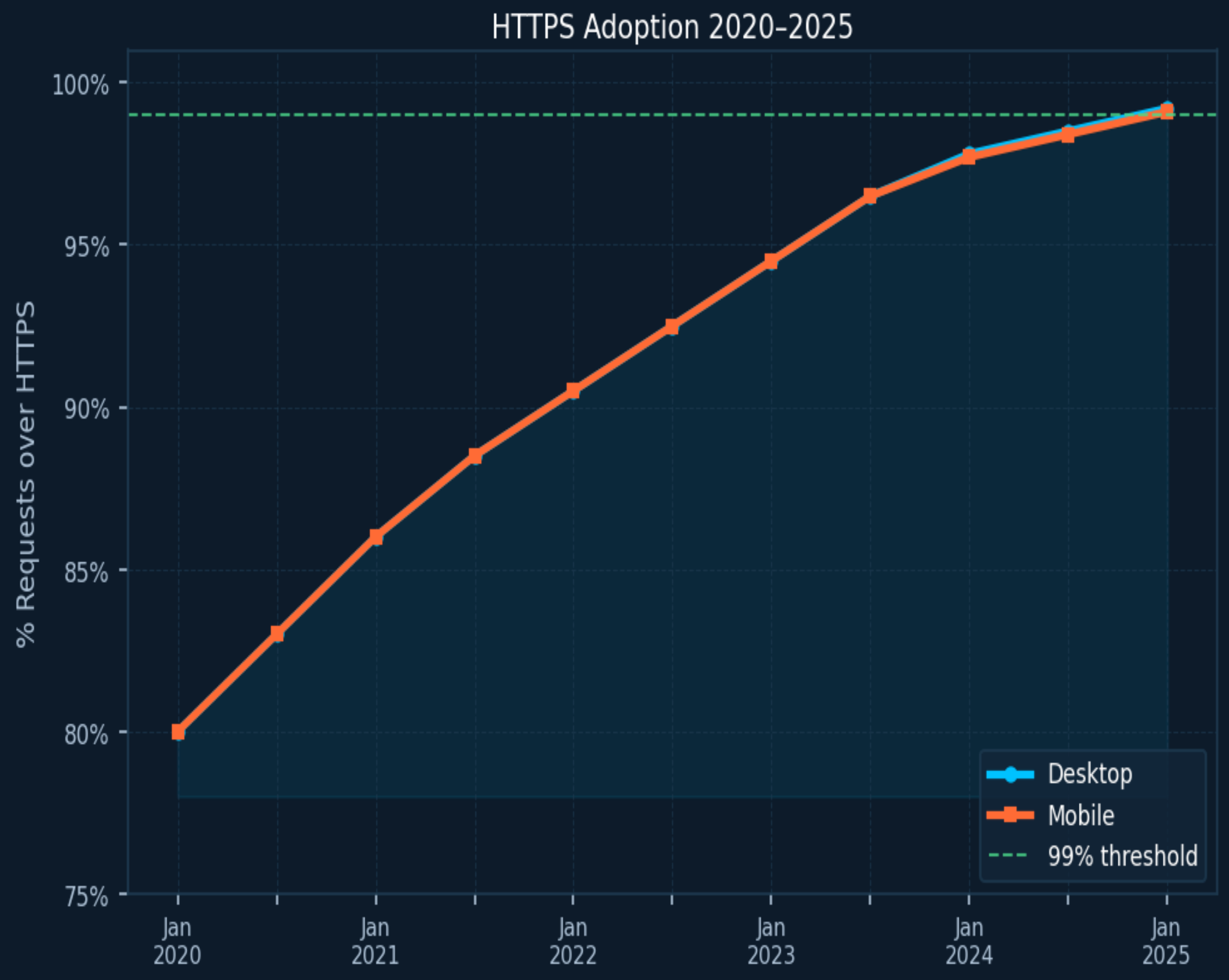
of all web requests now use HTTPS

99.2% Desktop requests

99.1% Mobile requests

▲ ~19–20pp Increase since 2020

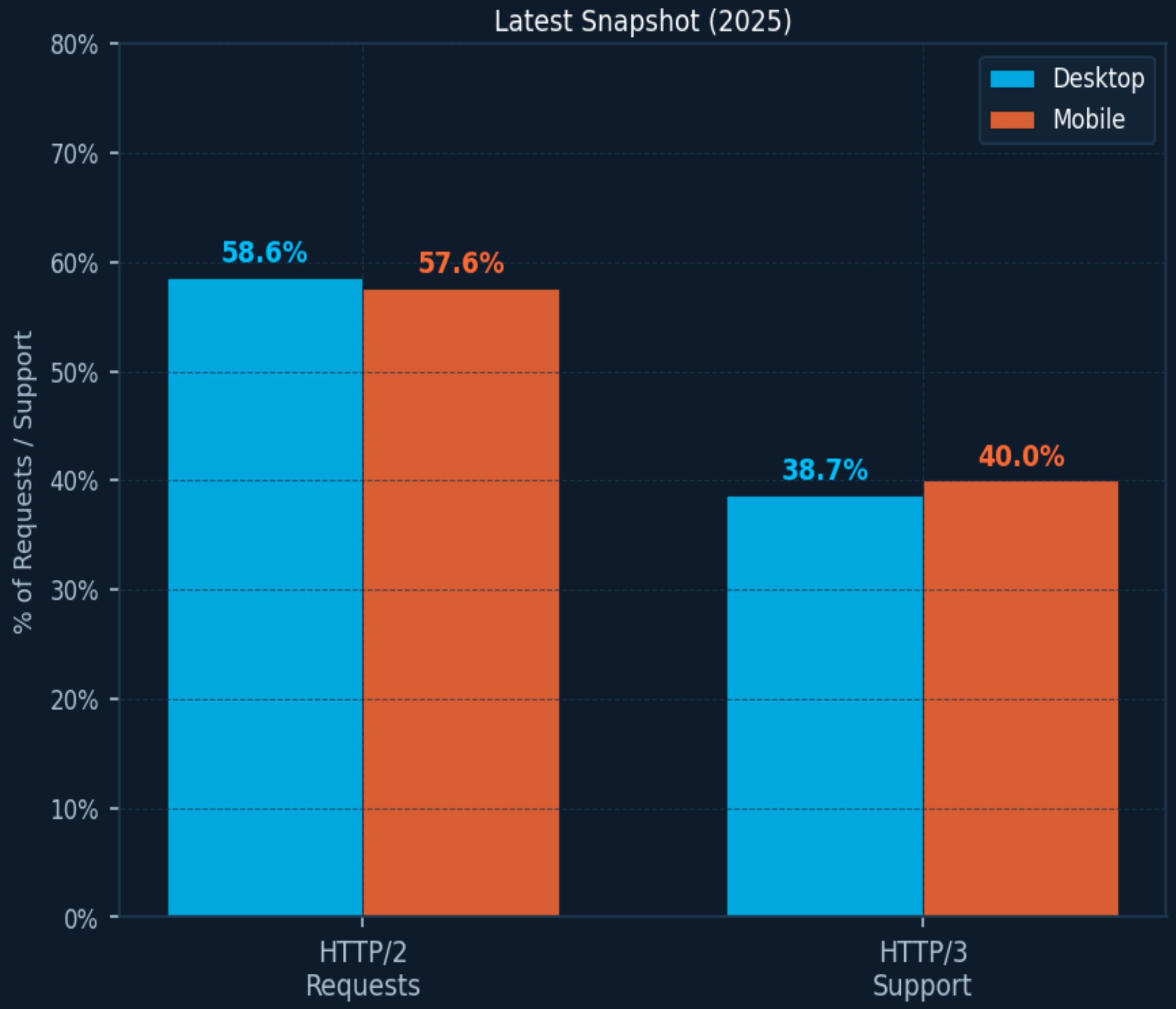
Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web

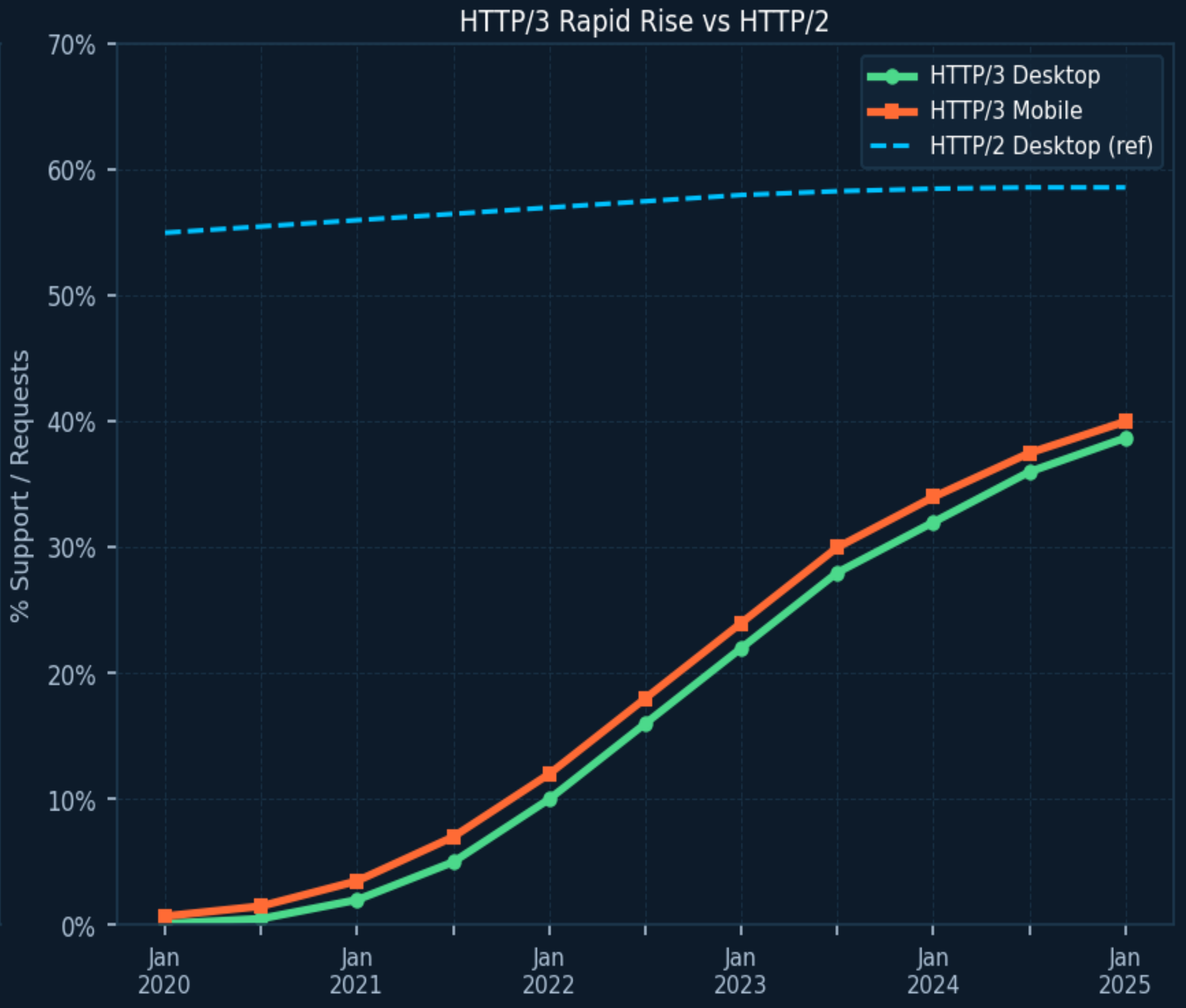


Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

HTTP/3 grew from near-zero to ~40% support in under four years · Fresh Chrome defaults to HTTP/2 on first connection

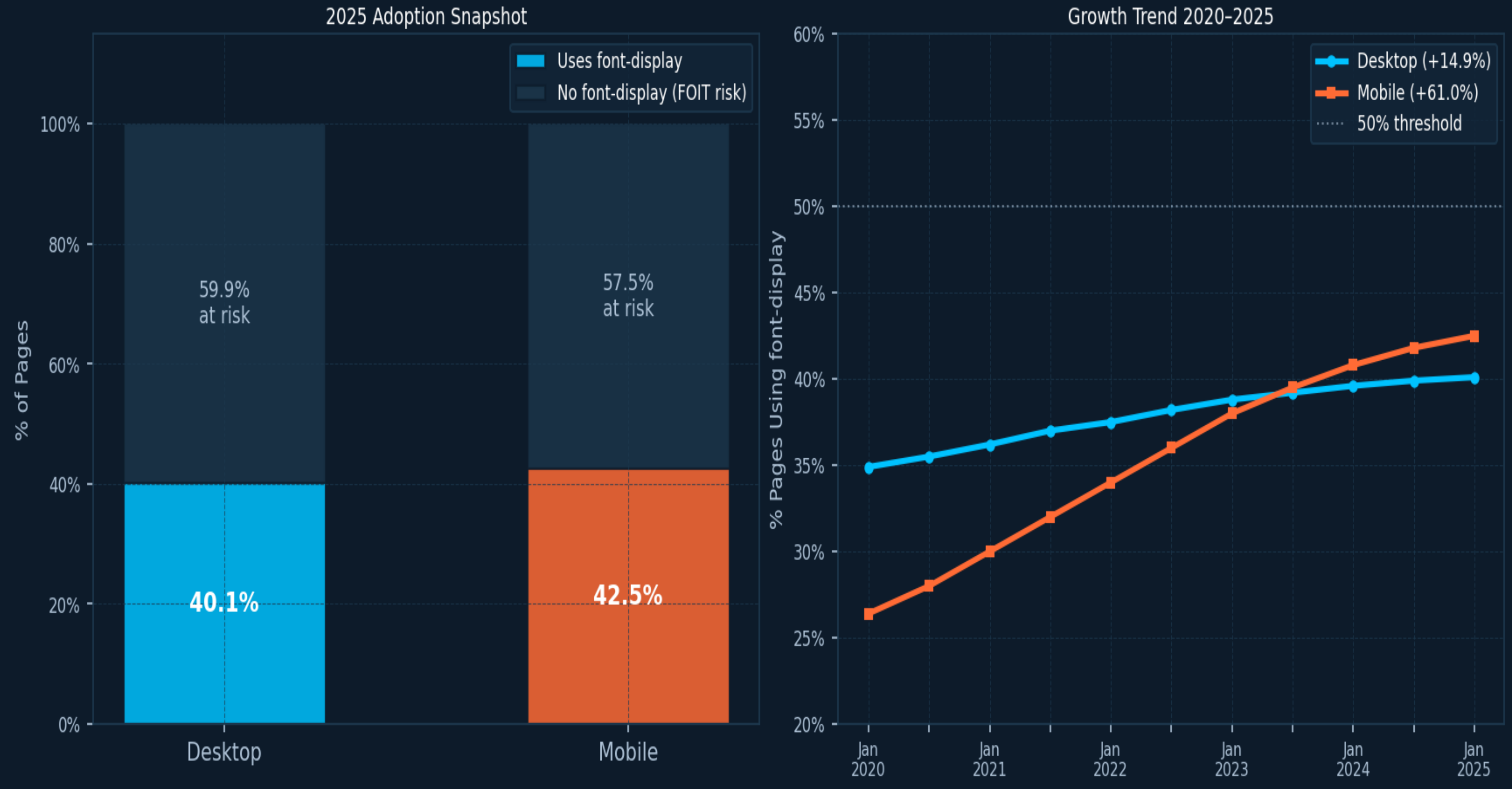




ⓘ Measurement note: HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support (Alt-Svc), not actual usage — fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 capability

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020

font-display: swap prevents Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) — but more than half of pages still at risk



FOIT Risk

>50% of pages

still lack font-display property

Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

Five macro-level findings from HTTP Archive · Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

1. Page Weight Keeps Climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB — ~25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript. Performance budgets must evolve accordingly.

2. HTTPS Is the New Baseline

At 99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile, unencrypted HTTP is effectively extinct. Sites not yet on HTTPS are outliers; TLS configuration quality is the next frontier.

3. HTTP/3 Is the Fastest-Growing Protocol Metric

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years. Ensure your CDN and origin advertise HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc — the infrastructure wave is already here.

4. Fewer TCP Connections Despite More Requests

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median connections per page by 15–27%. Connection overhead is falling even as request counts nudge upward.

5. Font-Display Still Underused

At ~40–42% adoption, more than half of pages still risk FOIT on font load. A single CSS property (font-display: swap) can eliminate the issue — low-effort, high-impact.

→ Benchmark your own site against these baselines and prioritize the gaps that move your users' Core Web Vitals.

Source: HTTP Archive — httparchive.org

Benchmark your site

httparchive.org · web.dev/measure · PageSpeed Insights